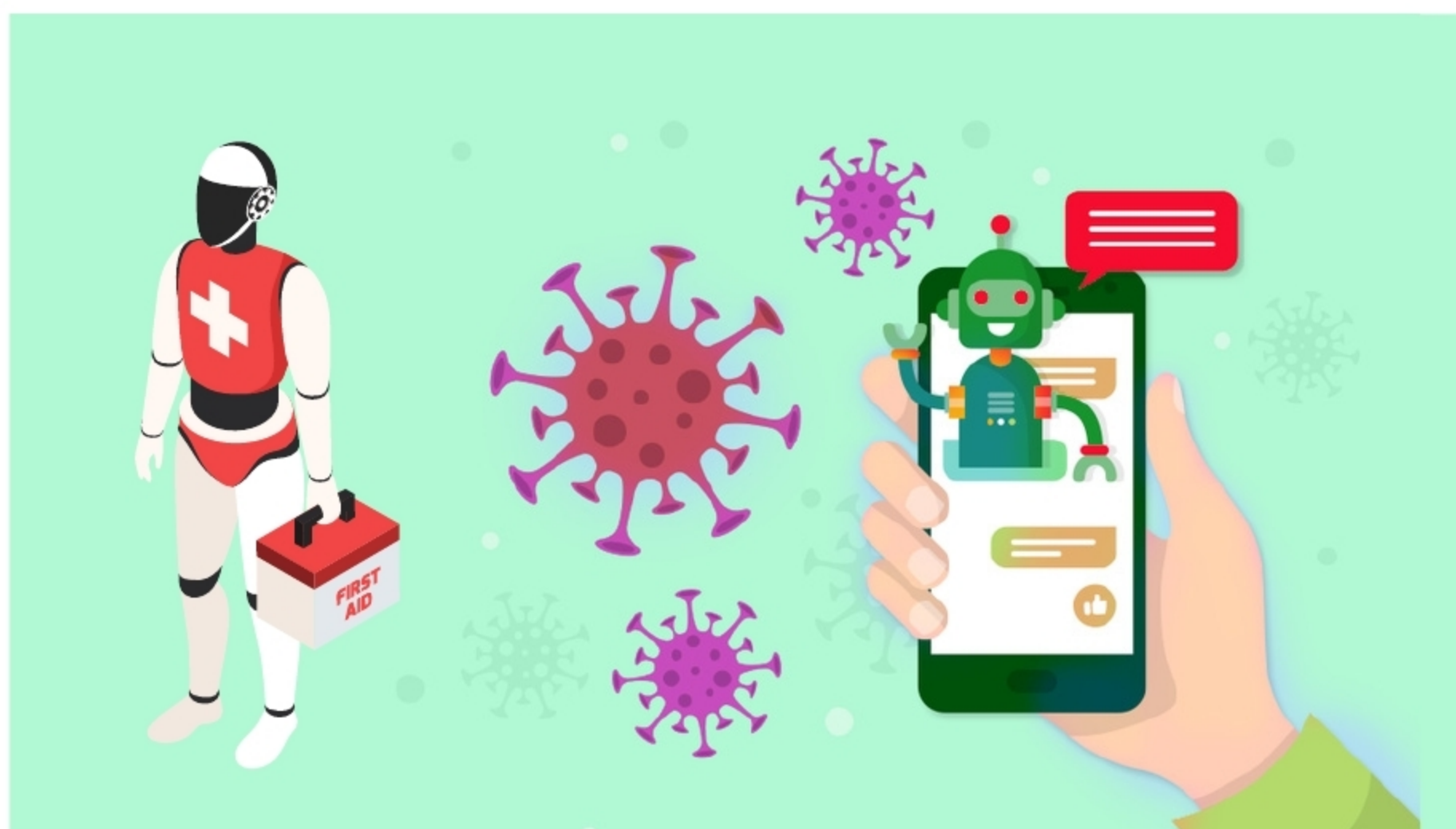


Artificial Intelligence can Help us Survive any Pandemic

Public health emergency management is not just about physicians or patients. It is also about technology professionals developing solutions to mitigate adverse impacts. From artificial intelligence (AI) to the Internet of Things (IoT), a spectrum of technological solutions can be leveraged to deliver better healthcare services. In this article, we will explore these possibilities.



Can the world be ready for the next pandemic? With AI, yes! With the outbreak of the COVID-19 pandemic, medical practitioners and public policy thinkers have used new technologies such as artificial intelligence (AI), machine learning (ML), the Internet of Things (IoT), and automation for technology-driven disaster response systems. All of these can be put to great use to fight the current and any future pandemic.

Healthcare AI-powered bots

AI-powered chatbots can help medical practitioners in disease testing, vital stats monitoring, and primary care. A few years back, chatbots used to be query-to-retrieve computer programs that rendered relevant text documents based on keyword matches. Today, with AI, chatbots have evolved to become smart, understanding both the keywords and the search intent behind those keywords. Messenger bots can be deployed to perform disease symptom checks, identify the possible

medical conditions, and perform preliminary diagnosis. AI and ML healthcare chatbots, emerging to be called symptom checkers, can reduce unnecessary doctor visits.

Developers have a range of NLP libraries to choose from — from Microsoft's Bot framework to Rasa and Wit.ai. Wit.ai is a very popular open source framework. Recently procured by Facebook, it seems to be dominating the market with its 'easy to deploy' entities and intent. Wit.ai has SDKs compatible with iOS, Node.js,

